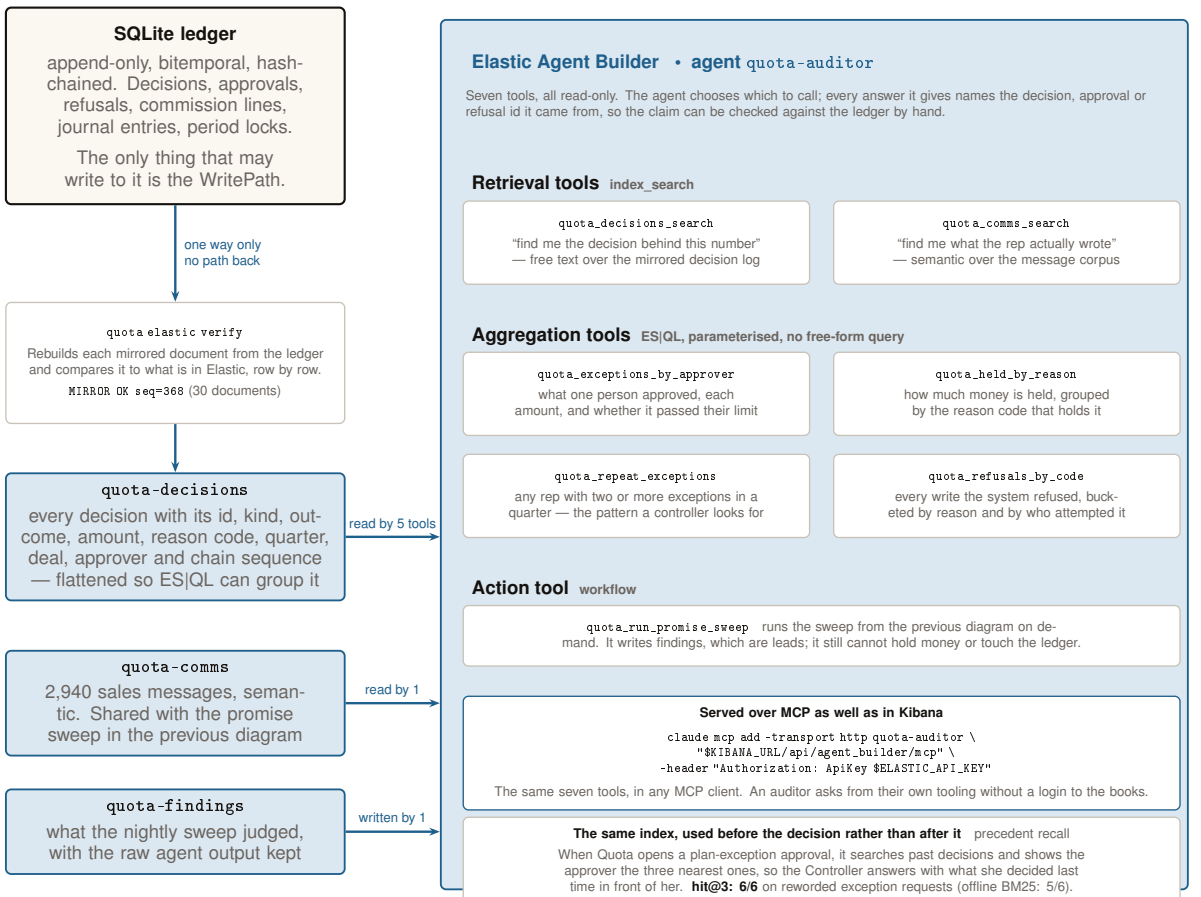
Elastic in the workflow, 2 of 2: the decision mirror and the auditor who can be questioned

A ledger that can be questioned in English is worth more at an audit than one that can only be queried in SQL. Quota mirrors its decision log into Elastic **one way** and hash-verified, and puts an Agent Builder agent in front of it with seven read-only tools. The books stay in SQLite; Elastic answers questions about them.



ASKED AND ANSWERED

The rehearsal, run live against the project — including the one it got wrong

Question, asked in English	Tools the agent chose	Time	What came back
"Why is Riley's Summit commission held? Show the evidence."	held_by_reason decisions_search comms_search	40.0 s	**Right.** D-0014, $6,000.00, OFF_CONTRACT_COMMITMENT, the exact quote with its file and row, and A-0009 still pending with Priya Nair.
"What did Marcus approve this half, and was any of it over his limit?"	exceptions_by_approver decisions_search refusals_by_code	102.3 s	**Partly wrong, and the fault was ours.** The limit finding was right (A-0001, $6,000 over a $5,000 limit, routed on as A-0002), but the mirror had taken Marcus's grant message as the rep, so the agent said he approved "for himself". **Fixed:** the mirror now names a rep only for an AE, and quota_exceptions_by_approver(marcus.lee) returns one approval, $6,000, approved, with no rep.
"Did anyone try to bypass a control?"	refusals_by_code decisions_search exceptions_by_approver	39.9 s	**Right on the refusal:** R-0001, the analyst seat attempting to decide A-0002, refused with NO_CAPABILITY. One sentence about who had already approved what was wrong, from the same mirror bug.
"Any rep with repeated exceptions in 2026Q2?"	repeat_exceptions	—	The agent's model hit Elastic's trial rate limit, so the agent's own ES|QL tool was run directly through /api/agent_builder/tools/_execute: **no rows**. No rep has two or more exceptions in the quarter.

THE LINE WE DREW

Elastic is read-only on the books. Nothing in Agent Builder holds a capability in the WritePath, so no answer, finding or hallucination from this layer can book, hold, release or pay anything. The worst a wrong answer can do is send a person to look at the wrong decision id — and the id is printed, so they find out in one click.

The mirror is one way and checked. verify rebuilds every mirrored document from the ledger and compares it. A drifted mirror is a loud failure, not a quiet one: that is how the Marcus bug above was found and fixed.

Quota runs without Elastic. The search interface has two backends; with no project configured it falls back to a local index, which is how the payout gate is scored offline (52/52). Lose Elastic and the books still close — what is lost is the nightly sweep over messages nobody reads, and the ability to ask the ledger a question in English.

What is reported here is what was measured on 2026-10-25 against Elastic Serverless 9.6 with .jina-embeddings-v5-text-small and .jina-reranker-v3.5, written down before it was known whether the numbers flattered us. The wrong answer above is left in on purpose.